

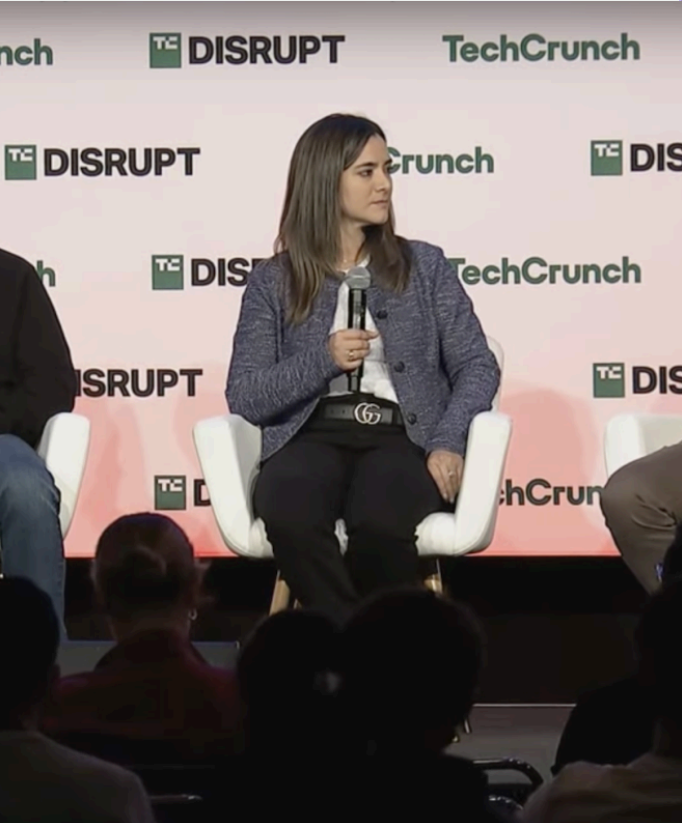
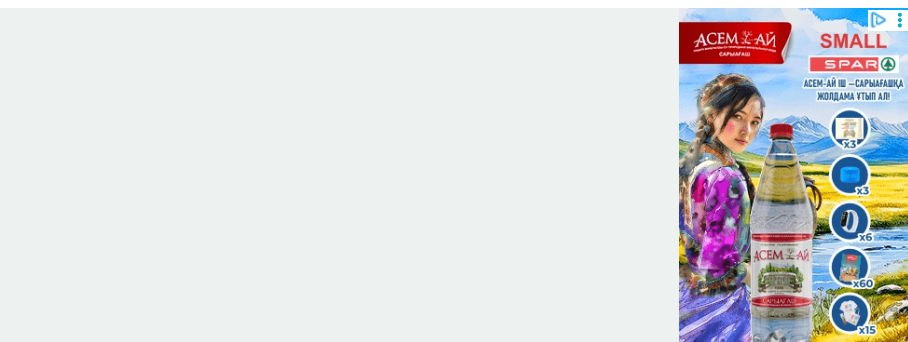


IMAGE CREDITS: SLAVA BLAZER PHOTOGRAPHY / GETTY IMAGES

AI



Onstage at TechCrunch Disrupt 2025: How AI is forcing late-stage startups to rewire GTM — or be left behind

TechCrunch Events — 7:30 AM PDT · July 22, 2025

AI isn't just disrupting products — it's upending how companies sell, scale, and succeed. At [TechCrunch Disrupt 2025](#), happening October 27-29 in San Francisco, we're diving deep into how late-stage startups are navigating this shift. Catch this dynamic panel on the [Going Public Stage](#), where three seasoned leaders will explore how AI is transforming go-to-market (GTM) strategies from the inside out.

TC DISRUPT

October 27-29, 2025 | San Francisco

Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

[Book Your Table >](#)



Why attend this session?

If you're scaling a startup and wondering how AI fits into your next phase of growth, this conversation is for you. [Our panelists](#) will cut through the hype to reveal how AI is changing everything, from sales and marketing to customer success. You'll get insight into what's working, what's not, and how to integrate AI into your GTM motion without derailing your focus or team.

Meet the speakers

[Nirav Tolia](#) is the CEO, president, and co-founder of [Nextdoor](#), where he leads one of the most recognized community platforms in tech. Tolia previously co-founded and led Epinions.com, was COO at Shopping.com, and serves as the non-executive chair of Hedosophia.

[Jane Alexander](#), partner at [CapitalG](#), brings more than 15 years of experience building and scaling GTM teams. Before joining CapitalG, she was CMO at Carta and held leadership roles at Salesforce and RelateIQ.

[Vanessa Larco](#) is the co-founder of [Premise](#) and a former partner at NEA. With a background in product leadership and investing, Larco brings a sharp lens to how startups can grow efficiently — and stay focused — as AI reshapes product and market strategies.

Snag your July discount and get ready for Disrupt 2025

Don't miss this session — [and more than 200 others](#) — at the tech epicenter where 10,000+ startup and VC leaders connect to discover the next wave of innovation. [Buy your tickets now](#) and save up to \$675 before July savings end.

Topics: [AI](#) [Disrupt2025](#) [Startups](#) [TC](#) [TC Event Promo](#) [TechCrunch Disrupt](#)

[TechCrunch Disrupt 2025](#)

Most Popular



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- Spotify raises subscription prices
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- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines
- The best dating apps aren't even dating apps



IMAGE CREDITS: PHILLIP FARAONE / GETTY IMAGES

FUNDRAISING



How to actually raise a seed round: Actionable advice from top investors at TechCrunch Disrupt 2025

TechCrunch Events — 11:48 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

[TechCrunch Disrupt 2025](#) returns to Moscone West in San Francisco from October 27-29, bringing together more than 10,000 startup and VC leaders for an inside look at where innovation is headed. Among the must-attend sessions is a candid panel on the Builders Stage about one of the most high-stakes moments in any founder's journey: raising your first round.

[Register now to save up to \\$675 on your ticket](#) and join this conversation — plus 200+ more sessions across five industry stages, roundtables, and breakouts. Prices go up tonight at 11:59 p.m. PT.



From pitch to partnership: The real roadmap to seed funding

This dynamic panel brings together three seasoned investors — Maria Palma (Freestyle Capital), Gabby Cazeau (Harlem Capital), and Marlon Nichols (MaC Venture Capital) — to unpack the realities of early-stage fundraising. From shaping a compelling pitch to choosing the right capital partners, they'll

share honest, actionable insights to help founders translate interest into investment.

[Maria Palma](#), general partner at [Freestyle Capital](#), brings deep operating and investing experience, with past roles at Kindred Capital, RRE Ventures, and leadership positions at high-growth startups like Eyeview. She’s backed companies such as Fung Money, Lightning Labs, and Payman, and holds an MBA from Harvard.

[Gabby Cazeau](#) is a partner at [Harlem Capital](#), investing in pre-seed and seed startups across enterprise software and applied AI. She holds an MBA from Yale and a BS in chemical engineering. Gabby has been featured in Business Insider, CNBC, and Crain’s 40 Under 40, and serves on the VC Council of Startup:NYC.

[Marlon Nichols](#), co-founder and managing general partner of [MaC Venture Capital](#), leads one of North America’s top seed-stage firms with over \$600 million AUM (assets under management). A multiple-time honoree on Business Insider’s Seed 100 and PitchBook’s list of top Black VCs, Marlon has helped scale industry-shaping companies like Blavity, Thrive Market, and MongoDB.

What to expect on the Builders Stage

This isn’t your typical venture panel. Expect sharp insights on how to cut through the noise, structure your raise, and build relationships that last beyond a term sheet. Whether you’re gearing up for your first round or advising a founder who is, this is the session you don’t want to miss.

TC

Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They’re here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don’t miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

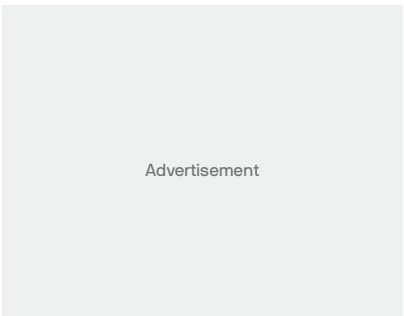
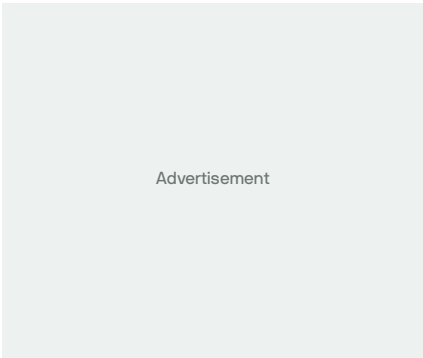
San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

REGISTER NOW

Catch Palma, Cazeau, Nichols, and [250+ tech heavyweights](#) across the six industry-specific stages, as well as in breakouts and roundtables, live at TechCrunch Disrupt 2025, at Moscone West in San Francisco. [Register now](#) and lock in up to \$675 in ticket savings before today ends!

Topics: [Disrupt 2025](#) [Fundraising](#) [Startups](#) [TC](#) [TC Event Promo](#)

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VENTURE



Final call: TechCrunch Disrupt 2025 ticket savings end tonight

TechCrunch Events — 6:00 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

TechCrunch Disrupt 2025 marks 20 years of shaping the startup world — and tonight's your last chance to save up to \$675 on your ticket.

From October 27–29, Disrupt returns to Moscone West in San Francisco. Join 10,000+ tech innovators, founders, VCs, and ecosystem builders for three days of high-impact programming, networking, and startup energy.

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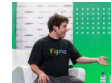
How to actually raise a seed round: Actionable advice from top investors at TechCrunch Disrupt 2025

But first: your savings. You have until 11:59 p.m. PT tonight to save up to \$675. Once the clock strikes midnight, prices jump. [Register now.](#)

TechCrunch Events
- 14 hours ago



STARTUPS



Figma's IPO success is 'a little bit of a meme stock,' says Sapphire Ventures' Jai Das

Rebecca Bellan,
Theresa Loconsolo
- 16 hours ago

TECHCRUNCH DISRUPT 2025



Final call: TechCrunch Disrupt 2025 ticket savings end tonight

TechCrunch Events
- 20 hours ago

Why you won't want to miss this 20th-anniversary Disrupt

TechCrunch Disrupt has been the launchpad for breakthroughs and next-generation deals for 20 years. It's not just another tech conference — it's where game-changing innovations are born, powerful connections are made, and ideas turn into action.

One session, one meeting, one moment — that's all it takes to change your trajectory. Disrupt is where startups break out, investors find the next big thing, and industry leaders stay ahead of the curve.

Featured Disrupt 2025 speakers

- Roelof Botha, [Sequoia Capital](#)
- Jeff Cardenas, [Apptironik](#)
- David George, [Andreessen Horowitz](#)
- Alex Kendall, [Wayve](#)
- Eunice Kim, [Netflix](#)
- Tekedra Mawakana, [Waymo](#)
- Alejandro Matamala Ortiz, [Runway](#)
- Ryan Petersen, [Flexport](#)
- Mati Staniszewski, [ElevenLabs](#)
- Astro Teller, [X](#), [The Moonshot Factory](#)
- Ethan Thornton, [Mach Industries](#)
- Nirav Tolia, [Nextdoor](#)
- Raquel Urtasun, [Waabi](#)
- Eric Yuan, [Zoom](#)
- Sangeen Zeb, [GV \(Google Ventures\)](#)

- ...and many more. New speakers are announced weekly. [Check the speaker page](#) often.



IMAGE CREDITS:HAJE KAMPS / TECHCRUNCH

Here's what's happening at Disrupt

Four Industry stages + the Disrupt Stage

Dive into the tools, trends, and tactics founders need to grow, scale, and lead in a competitive market. Stay tuned as new sessions are frequently added to [the agenda](#).

- **Builders Stage:** Growth playbooks and founder realities
- **AI Stage:** Two days covering agents, creativity, defense, EV, hardware, and regulation
- **Space Stage:** Where tech meets the cosmos
- **Going Public Stage:** Candid lessons from companies that made it

Interactive sessions

Join candid conversations with startup pros in small-group roundtables and breakout sessions. Ask real questions, get unfiltered answers, and gain in-depth insights not covered on the big stages.



Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025

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IMAGE CREDITS: TECHCRUNCH

Startup Battlefield 200

Watch the top 20 TechCrunch–picked startups pitch live on the Disrupt Stage for a \$100,000 equity-free prize — with real-time VC feedback.

Explore what's next

Step into the Expo Hall and meet the startups creating tomorrow's tech. Founders: Want in? [Exhibit your startup](#) and get in front of investors, media, and future customers, before tables run out.

Make the right connections

Disrupt isn't about meeting *more* people — it's about meeting the *right* ones. Braindate helps you find those key conversations that move your goals forward, whether in a 1:1 or small-group format.

Additional benefits for investors and founders

The Deal Flow Café is where investors and founders connect over coffee to talk deals, raise rounds, and spark momentum.

In addition to access to the Deal Flow Café, Investor and Founder Pass holders unlock exclusive benefits designed to make an impact:

- **Investors:** Enjoy a curated tour of the Expo Hall with formal introductions to startups that align with your investment focus. Plus, your reserved seat at the exclusive **StrictlyVC** session on Day 2 awaits.
- **Founders:** Get face time with investors actively scouting for their next big bet, whether you're raising now or building for what's next.



IMAGE CREDITS: TECHCRUNCH

Savings disappear after tonight

You've got until 11:59 p.m. PT tonight to save up to \$675 on your Disrupt 2025 ticket. Don't miss one of the most anticipated tech conferences of the year. [Register now](#) and lock in your savings before prices go up after tonight.

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The votes are in: TechCrunch Disrupt 2025 Audience Choice winners revealed for roundtables and breakouts

TC DIS
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Invited — they made it onto the [TechCrunch Disrupt 2025](#) agenda!

After reviewing hundreds of standout Call for Content submissions and opening the vote to the TechCrunch audience, we've locked in the top five roundtables and top five breakout sessions.



Without further ado, meet the exceptional tech voices — and the sessions they'll lead — that will shape the conversation at Disrupt 2025, taking place October 27-29 at San Francisco's Moscone West. [Visit the agenda page](#) for full session and speaker details.

[Grab your ticket now and save up to \\$675 before prices increase.](#)

Breakout session winners

From Vibes to Velocity: How AI Tools Can Help You Achieve Your Development Goals



[Tim Rogers](#)

Staff Product Manager
GitHub Copilot

With vibe coding on the rise, devs are looking to move faster and ship smarter. In this breakout, GitHub PM Tim Rogers dives into Copilot — the AI-powered peer programming tool used by more than 15 million — and how it's reshaping workflows in an autonomous world.

How to Get Acquired in Tech (Without Selling Out): M&A Tips for Founders and Builders



[Akil Ibssa](#)

Head of Corporate Development and M&A
Coinbase

Coinbase just pulled off crypto's biggest acquisition. In this no-BS session, learn how to make your project irresistible — from product-market fit to community traction — and position for M&A, investment, or partnership without compromising decentralization. If you're an investor, you'll get a cheat sheet for spotting teams building toward high-value outcomes.

AI at the Brink: Strategic Playbook for National Security

DISRUPT

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Put your brand in front of 10,000+ tech and VC leaders across all three days of Disrupt 2025. Amplify your reach, spark real connections, and lead the innovation charge. Secure your exhibit space before your competitor does.

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- Key sections of the US Constitution deleted from government's website
- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue's AI-generated ad isn't just about fashion
- Lina Khan points to Figma IPO as vindication of M&A scrutiny
- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines



[Daniel Hendrycks](#)

Executive Director
Center for AI Safety (CAIS)

Advanced AI brings risks like bioweapons and cyberattacks amid global competition. This session explores strategic frameworks for AI safety, covering technical checks, non-proliferation, and supply chain security with Dan Hendrycks and key experts.



Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

San Francisco | October 27-29, 2025

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Embracing AI for a Better Digital Future



[Matt Madrigal](#)

Chief Technology Officer
Pinterest

AI is at a crossroads, shaping whether it is additive or addictive, inclusive or harmful. Matt shows how Pinterest uses AI for positivity, personalization, and productivity, offering a responsible approach that drives innovation while prioritizing user well-being.

Agentic AI for Startups: Automate, Adapt, and Accelerate Growth



[Anmol Rastogi](#)

Head of Product Management, AI & ML
Amazon Business Amazon

Agentic AI is transforming startups by enabling automation, personalized experiences, and data-driven agility. This session covers identifying AI opportunities, building workflows, and measuring impact using real case studies to help founders accelerate growth and outpace competition.

Roundtable session winners

The Winning Formula: Turning Your Business Into a Trusted, Scalable Community To Drive Growth

[Justine Palefsky](#) and [Tasneem Amina](#)

Co-Founders

Kindred

Join Kindred co-founders Justine Palefsky and Tasneem Amina as they reveal how they transformed home swapping into a community-led movement. Learn their blueprint for building trust, turning members into ambassadors, and driving growth through authentic, values-driven community building.

How to Train Your Model: Taming AI Agents Without Breaking Them

[Kyla Guru](#)

Head of Model Cyber Safety

Anthropic

This interactive session dives into balancing AI safety and usefulness, covering constitutional AI, red-teaming, and steering methods. Attendees will gain frameworks and strategies to build AI models that are both helpful and harmless without losing personality.

Future of Space Economy in the Low Earth Orbit

[Abhi Kumar](#)

Lecturer, Investor, and Advisor

UC Berkeley

Low Earth Orbit (LEO) is evolving beyond satellites into manufacturing, energy, and data infrastructure. This session covers the emerging LEO economy, regulations, and investments, offering insights on partnering with space startups and leveraging orbital platforms for Earth industries.

Scaling Search and AI for Millions: Lessons from Reddit Search

[Rachel Miller](#)

Product Manager

Reddit

Explore how Reddit builds AI at scale, balancing relevance, safety, and bias for millions of users. This session tackles community expectations, ethical tradeoffs, and real-world challenges, inviting startups to join a candid discussion on trusted AI development.

AI Evaluation 101: Addressing Challenges to Real-World AI Applications

[Rohit Patel](#)

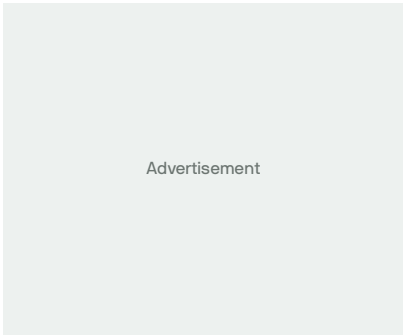
Director, Meta Superintelligence Labs
Meta

This session breaks down how neural networks generate language and the challenges of deploying GenAI. Learn why evaluation matters and compare automated, judge-based, and human-rated methods to build tests that measure AI versus human performance for your use case.

Join these sessions — and much more — live at Disrupt 2025

These 10 sessions are just a glimpse of the 250+ speakers and talks at Disrupt. Keep an eye on the [agenda page](#) for new updates, and [grab your ticket now](#) to save up to \$675 before prices rise.

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